

rubberised foot pegs that go hand in hand with a great design. Three LEDs on the front panel indicate the power, read and write status of the device. This was the only external CD-Writer that can be vertically mounted and lets you burn your CDs in this position. Again, the only thing that seemed wrong was the power switch located inconveniently at the rear of the drive.

One of the lightest and most compact Writers that we received was the Sony CRXP-90MU. A 24x Writer, the drive is also capable of reading memory sticks and provides a button underneath its body for rescuing jammed CDs. The Freecom Traveler II, a 16x device, was also small in size and appropriately lightweight. This drive comes with a handy rechargeable backup battery, but its average build quality is prone to damage on the move. The laptop-type drive loading mechanism might not be appreciated by all users, since one has to manually pull the tray out, even after pressing the eject button. The huge, impractical size of the Yamaha CRW3200UX-VK made us doubt its capability as a portable device. Although the drive features a good build quality, its average looks mar its overall aesthetic value, while a short USB cable takes away from ease of use.

Warranty and support

Here we logged the period of warranty for each of the devices and even noted down the type of support provided for this drives by different brands. All the brands in this shootout offer to replace the faulty drive within the warranty period.

Buying Tips



- Choose a compact device that will fit into your luggage unobtrusively
- The device should be light enough for you to carry along for long distances
- Buying a device that offers a lower cost per MB is advisable
- Choose a device for which the media is easily available
- Always investigate the details of the warranty and take them down in writing

What it all leads to

The tests showed that external hard drives provide the best portable solution in terms of performance and storage space. This makes it an ideal choice for those who work with image and video editing applications that require huge amounts of space. But the Zip drive, on the other hand, stores your data securely for a longer period of time. And if you need to swap data frequently between devices, the best choice would be a CD-Writer. Even though the initial price of the device may be high, the media is cheap and easily available.

The winners!

The winner of the Best Performance Award in our test is the Freecom FHD-1 20 GB drive. This drive managed to outrun every other contender in the comparison in terms of pure

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